

Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion — User Guides

User Guides

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Release: 2026.07

Instructor, pilot, arranging, and educational guidance

0.1 Manual volumes in this release

PDF	Description
00-Trainers-Manual.pdf	Field teaching handbook for instructors and pilot collaborators
01-Specifications.pdf	Identity framework, blueprint, design principles, notation standards
02-Reference.pdf	Concept library, technique, grids, sound model
03-User-Guides.pdf	Instructor, pilot, arranging, and educational guidance
04-Research.pdf	Indigenous percussion, Kaamulan, marching heritage

PDF	Description
05-Architecture.pdf	Documentation architecture and ADRs
06-Governance.pdf	EDF governance, metadata, change management
07-AI-Development.pdf	AI-assisted workflow and project development notes
08-Templates-and-Placeholders.pdf	Templates and inactive EDF domain placeholders

1 User Guides

Practical guidance for arrangers, educators, performers, and project users.

1.1 Contents

- [Instructor Introduction](#) — **start here** for educators and pilot collaborators
- [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#) — Misamis Oriental National High School (MONHS) Drum & Lyre Corps 2026 show pilot
- [Arranging Guide](#) — applying identity and concepts to writing
- [Educational Handbook](#) — teaching methodology
- Student Handouts — planned

1.2 Audience Entry Points

Audience	Start with
Music educators and Drum & Lyre instructors	Instructor Introduction
MONHS 2026 pilot instructors (Misamis Oriental National High School)	MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief
Arrangers	Arranging Guide

1.3 Related Documents

- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Design Principles](#)

2 Instructor Introduction

Status: Maintained **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Music educators, section leaders, and pilot instructors **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-13 **Review Frequency:** Quarterly **Authoritative:** Yes

2.1 Purpose

This document introduces the Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project to music educators and Drum & Lyre instructors. It is the recommended **first read** for anyone joining the project as a teacher or pilot collaborator.

It explains the vision, what collaboration looks like, and how your expertise fits—without requiring familiarity with the project’s internal documentation system.

2.2 Who This Is For

- Drum & Lyre corps instructors and section leaders
- School music educators planning show material
- Cultural practitioners whose festival and community performance experience informs the project
- Anyone evaluating whether this approach fits their ensemble

If you are preparing to work on a specific pilot engagement, also read the [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief for Misamis Oriental National High School \(MONHS\)](#).

2.3 The Vision in Plain Language

The project aims to establish a **new, distinctly Filipino modern marching percussion tradition**.

The goal is **not** to sound like Drum Corps International (DCI), Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCU) groups, or military drum corps.

The goal **is** to preserve and elevate what already makes Philippine Drum & Lyre and festival percussion powerful—then add modern technique, notation, and ensemble sophistication **only where it strengthens Filipino identity**.

The guiding philosophy is:

Modernization without imitation.

Every major musical decision should answer:

“Does this preserve Philippine identity while improving musicianship?”

The full philosophy is defined in the [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#).

2.4 What We Are Building

This is more than a collection of scores. The project is developing:

- a documented teaching approach that respects ear-based learning while adding written literacy
- original warm-ups, cadences, and show material rooted in Philippine groove
- arranging methods that layer festival energy with selected modern battery technique
- practice audio and notation suited to Philippine school environments
- a reusable system future educators can adapt

Finished music lives in `scores/` and `audio/`. Teaching and arranging guidance lives in `docs/User_Guides/`.

2.5 Your Expertise Matters

Instructors from Bukidnon and other festival-rich regions bring knowledge this project cannot invent from documentation alone.

If you have grown up with Kaamulan, community festival drumming, or regional rhythmic traditions, **you are a cultural authority—not a student of our research notes**. The project treats festival traditions as inspiration and foundation, not as material to copy note-for-note.

We are asking for your judgment on questions such as:

- Does this groove still feel Filipino?
- Is this respectful to the traditions it draws from?
- Will this work for our students and our instruments?
- Does this performance energy match how our community celebrates through percussion?

Insights from pilot work may be recorded—with your consent—in the [Project Journal](#) and [Research](#) documents.

2.6 How Teaching Fits the Project

2.6.1 Blended literacy

Many Philippine lines learn primarily by ear. That develops listening, memory, feel, and cultural continuity. This project **adds** notation and structured pedagogy as tools—it does not replace oral tradition.

2.6.2 Groove before speed

Students should feel the Philippine rhythmic foundation before pursuing technical display.

2.6.3 Movement integrated with music

Festival and community performance traditions connect sound, movement, and audience energy. Rehearsal should preserve that connection.

2.6.4 Progressive development

Complexity is introduced gradually. Materials must remain teachable in real school environments with varying reading levels and instrumentation.

Detailed teaching guidance will grow in the [Educational Handbook](#) as pilot work progresses.

2.7 The Three-Layer Arranging Idea (Brief)

When writing or evaluating show material, think in three layers:

Layer	Role	Source
The Soul	Native groove, bass momentum, cymbal energy	Philippine festival and Drum & Lyre traditions
The Precision	Rudimental and battery vocabulary over the groove	Selected DCI technique
The Contrast	Showmanship, breakdowns, metric shifts	Selected HBCU and contemporary influence

Philippine identity is always the foundation. International influences are **adapted**, not adopted as identity.

See the [Arranging Guide](#) and [Core Blueprint](#) for detail.

2.8 Identity Preservation Checklist

Before adopting a composition, exercise, arrangement, or rehearsal concept, consider:

- Does this preserve Philippine identity?
- Does it strengthen existing Philippine traditions?
- Is it culturally respectful?
- Does it improve musicianship?
- Is it practical for Philippine schools?
- Does it encourage creativity?
- Is it educationally sustainable?
- Are international influences supporting rather than dominating the music?
- Does the resulting performance still sound unmistakably Filipino?

The authoritative version appears in the [Identity Framework appendix \(Trainers Manual\)](#).

2.9 What We Ask of Pilot Instructors

1. **Read this introduction** and skim the Identity Framework vision and checklist.
2. **Share honest feedback** on teachability, cultural authenticity, and student response.
3. **Co-develop material** for your ensemble rather than treating scores as fixed products.
4. **Record observations**—what worked, what confused students, what felt most Filipino.
5. **Flag concerns early** if something feels disrespectful, impractical, or imitative.

2.10 Suggested Reading Order

Order	Document	Why
1	This document	Introduction and collaboration framing
2	MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief	If joining the Misamis Oriental National High School (MONHS) Drum & Lyre 2026 pilot
3	Identity Framework	Full musical constitution (vision, principles, checklist)
4	Educational Handbook	Teaching detail as it develops
5	Arranging Guide	If you write or adapt show music

2.11 Parent

- [User Guides](#)

2.12 Related Documents

- [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#)
- [Educational Handbook](#)
- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Design Principles](#)

- [Project Charter](#)
- [Kaamulan Festival](#)
- [Project Journal](#)

3 MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief

Status: Maintained **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Misamis Oriental National High School (MONHS) Drum & Lyre Corps instructors — 2026 show season **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-13 **Review Frequency:** Per season **Authoritative:** Yes

3.1 Purpose

This document describes the pilot collaboration between the Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project and music instructors at **MONHS** (Misamis Oriental National High School) instructing the **Drum & Lyre Corps** for the **2026 show**.

Read the [Instructor Introduction](#) first for project vision and collaboration principles.

3.2 Pilot Context

MONHS (Misamis Oriental National High School) is in Misamis Oriental. The pilot instructors collaborating on this project bring direct experience from **Bukidnon**, home of the **Kaamulan Festival**—one of the project’s primary cultural reference points. Their festival, community, and Drum & Lyre expertise is essential input, not background reading.

This pilot tests whether the project’s **modernization without imitation** approach works in a real school corps preparing show material for 2026.

3.3 What the Pilot Evaluates

- teachability of warm-ups, cadences, and show concepts with MONHS students
- cultural authenticity as judged by Bukidnon instructors
- blended ear-and-notation workflow in rehearsal
- practical fit for available instrumentation and reading levels
- audience and community response to the fusion style
- instructor feedback on arranging and pedagogy

3.4 Instructor Role

Pilot instructors are **collaborators**, not implementers of a fixed method.

We ask you to:

- apply the [Identity Preservation Checklist \(Trainers Manual\)](#) when reviewing material
- adapt exercises and show ideas to your corps’s strengths and constraints
- share what translates well from festival and community traditions into Drum & Lyre writing
- document lessons learned for the [Project Journal](#)
- contribute cultural guidance on Kaamulan and regional traditions—the [Kaamulan Festival](#) research document should grow from your expertise

3.5 Material Scope (2026 Season)

Initial pilot deliverables may include:

- hybrid warm-up exercises in [Technique and Warm-ups](#)
- a proof-of-concept cadence in [Cadences](#)
- sectional practice audio in [Battery Splits](#)
- show arrangement concepts in [Show Arrangements](#)

Exact repertoire and timeline will be agreed with instructors during planning.

3.6 Cultural Collaboration

Bukidnon instructors are invited to lead conversation on:

- which festival rhythmic ideas translate respectfully into battery writing
- movement and audience-energy concepts appropriate for a school corps show
- regional diversity within Bukidnon traditions
- what must be preserved versus what can be modernized

The project follows [Translate Musical Ideas—Not Instruments \(Trainers Manual\)](#): we adapt groove, phrasing, and ensemble communication—not imitate indigenous instruments on modern drums.

3.7 Feedback and Documentation

Observations from MONHS pilot work should be shared with the project owner and may be recorded in:

- [Project Journal](#) — rehearsal and field-test notes
- [Kaamulan Festival](#) — cultural findings contributed by instructors
- [Educational Handbook](#) — teaching methods validated in pilot

3.8 Out of Scope for This Pilot

- formal national curriculum accreditation
- commercial publishing or distribution
- full competitive field-show design beyond MONHS 2026 needs
- replacing established MONHS oral-teaching traditions

3.9 Parent

- [User Guides](#)

3.10 Related Documents

- [Instructor Introduction](#)
- [Educational Handbook](#)
- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Project Charter](#)
- [Kaamulan Festival](#)

4 Arranging Guide

Status: Draft **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Arrangers and section leaders **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-13 **Review Frequency:** Quarterly **Authoritative:** Yes

4.1 Purpose

This guide explains how to apply concepts defined in the [Identity Framework](#), [Design Principles](#), and [Concept Library](#). It does not redefine project identity.

Educators new to the project should read the [Instructor Introduction](#) first.

4.2 How to Use This Guide

1. Read the Identity Framework and apply the [Identity Preservation Checklist](#) ([Trainers Manual](#)).
2. Consult relevant Concept Library entries.
3. Follow [Notation Standards](#) when writing parts.
4. Validate arrangements against the [Philippine Percussion Sound Model](#).

4.3 Arranging Responsibilities

This guide will explain how to:

- translate indigenous rhythms into battery writing
- layer traditional grooves as the harmonic and rhythmic foundation
- apply bass-drum philosophy rooted in festival momentum
- translate hand-drum articulation into battery textures
- preserve Philippine rhythmic identity while increasing musical sophistication
- use the three-layer method (soul, precision, contrast) from the [Core Blueprint](#)
- adapt writing for available local instrumentation

4.4 Three-Layer Method Summary

Layer	Role	Source
Layer A — The Soul	Native groove, bass momentum, cymbal energy	Philippine festival and Drum & Lyre traditions
Layer B — The Precision	Rudimental and battery vocabulary over the groove	Selected DCI technique
Layer C — The Contrast	Showmanship, breakdowns, metric shifts	Selected HBCU and contemporary influence

4.5 Related Documents

- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Design Principles](#)
- [Notation Standards](#)
- [Scores](#)

4.6 Status

Detailed arranging procedures are pending development. This document establishes scope and canonical references.

5 Educational Handbook

Status: Draft **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Educators, section leaders, and pilot instructors **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-13 **Review Frequency:** Quarterly **Authoritative:** Yes

5.1 Purpose

This handbook explains how to teach the ideas defined in the **Identity Framework** and **Design Principles**. It is practical instruction, not identity definition.

New educators should begin with the **Instructor Introduction**.

5.2 Teaching Responsibilities

This handbook will explain how to:

- study indigenous traditions as cultural context
- study festival drumming as rhythmic and performance foundation
- teach groove before speed
- integrate movement with music
- build cultural understanding alongside technique
- run rehearsal methodology suited to Philippine school environments
- support progressive student development from rote learning toward blended literacy

5.3 Pedagogical Foundation

The project introduces notation as an additional tool rather than a replacement for learning by ear. Traditional local lines develop listening, memory, feel, and cultural continuity. Written materials add repeatability, preservation, and advanced rhythmic organization.

See **Core Blueprint — Pedagogy (Specifications)**.

5.4 Hybrid Warm-Up System

Technical exercises combine marching-percussion fundamentals with Philippine rhythmic vocabulary. Initial subjects include **legatos**, double strokes, **accent-taps**, **8-8-16**, flams, and **grid exercises**.

DCI stick-height control is taught through accent groupings influenced by Philippine festival rhythms.

5.5 Rehearsal Methodology

This section will explain practical rehearsal methods suited to Philippine school environments. Policy guidance appears in **Design Principles — Rehearsal Methodology (Trainers Manual)**.

Planned content includes:

- call-and-response rehearsal habits and sectional listening
- movement integrated with musical phrasing
- audience connection and performance energy in standstill and parade contexts
- sectional balance for available instrumentation
- identity evaluation using the [Identity Preservation Checklist \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

See also [Call and Response — Practical Implementation \(Trainers Manual\)](#) and [Instructor Introduction](#).

Status: Detailed lesson sequences are pending development.

5.6 Related Documents

- [Instructor Introduction](#)
- [Legato Stroke](#)
- [Accent-Taps](#)
- [8-8-16 Exercise](#)
- [Grid Exercises](#)
- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Design Principles](#)
- [Arranging Guide](#)
- [Technique and Warm-ups](#)
- [Audio — Battery Splits](#)

5.7 Status

Detailed lesson plans and teaching sequences are pending development. This document establishes scope and canonical references.